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OF THE FORTNIGHT



Triumphant: India's Koneru Humpy after winning the FIDE World Rapid chess championship in New York. PTI

Humpy clinches second World Rapid chess title

India's Koneru Humpy beat Indonesia's Irine Kharisma Sukandar in Round 11 to win FIDE World Rapid Championship 2024 in Wall Street, New York on December 29.

Humpy finished joint-top in the 2023 Samarkand Rapid Championship before losing to eventual winner Anastasia Bodnaruk in tie-breaks.

This is Humpy's second World Rapid title after claiming the top spot in 2019 in Moscow. Humpy missed out on the Budapest Olympiad, where India won a historic double gold, due to personal reasons but recovered well to cap off 2024 with the Rapid title.

Going into the final round of the event, six players

— Ju Wenjhun, Kateryna Lagno, Harika Dronavalli, Afruza Khamdamova, Tan Zhongyi and Irene — apart from Humpy were leading the tournament with 7.5 points in 10 rounds.

All top boards ended in a draw before Humpy struck the winning blow against Irene.

Final standings (out of 11 points): 1. GM Humpy Koneru 8.5; 2. GM Ju Wenjun 8.0; 3. GM Kateryna Lagno 8.0; 4. GM Tan Zhongyi 8.0; 5. GM Harika Dronavalli 8.0; 6. WIM Afruza Khamdamova 8.0; 7. GM Alexandra Kosteniuk 8.0; 8. IM Bibisara Assaubayeva 7.5; 9. IM Irine Kharisma Sukandar 7.5; 10. IM Stavroula Tsolakidou 7.5.